The Glory and the Fall

1 Kings 8 · 1 Kings 10–11 · Deuteronomy 17:14–20

The big idea: The glory of God filled Solomon's temple, and Solomon confessed that heaven itself cannot contain God. Then the wisest king let his heart drift, breaking all three limits Deuteronomy set for kings, and the kingdom split. Jesus is greater than Solomon.

Before you meet: Read

1 Kings 8:1–30 | 1 Kings 11:1–13 | Matthew 12:42

Open (5 minutes)

What slowly pulls a heart away from God when no one is paying attention?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"A cloud filled the house of the LORD… for the _____ of the LORD filled the house of the LORD." *(1 Kings 8:10–11)*

"Behold, heaven and the highest heaven cannot _____ you; how much less this house that I have built!" *(1 Kings 8:27)*

"For when Solomon was old his wives turned away his _____ after other gods." *(1 Kings 11:4)*

"Something _____ than Solomon is here." *(Matthew 12:42)*

Discuss

1. Solomon said heaven cannot contain God, yet God put his name in the temple. How can both be true? *1 Kings 8:27–30*

2. Solomon broke all three limits for kings: horses, wives, and gold. Which of power, sex, or money pulls hardest on hearts today? *Deuteronomy 17:16–17; 1 Kings 10–11*

3. Solomon's heart turned away slowly, when he was old. What helps a heart stay faithful over a lifetime? *1 Kings 11:4, 9*

Memory verse

> *"But will God indeed dwell on the earth? Behold, heaven and the highest heaven cannot contain you; how much less this house that I have built!"*
>
> **1 Kings 8:27**

Pray

Ask God for wisdom for the decisions in front of you. Confess anything slowly drawing your heart away from him. Thank Jesus that he is greater than Solomon, the wisdom of God and the true temple, and that he holds on to the people he saves.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 30

The Glory and the Fall

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read 1 Kings 8:10–30 and 11:1–13 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (1 Kings 12 and 17–18).

Main points to land

1. The temple, begun in 966 BC on Mount Moriah, was filled with God's glory. Even so, heaven itself cannot contain God (1 Kings 6:1; 8:10–11, 27).
2. Solomon broke the king's limits and let his heart drift after other gods, and the kingdom split after his death (Deuteronomy 17:16–17; 1 Kings 11:4, 11–13).
3. Jesus is greater than Solomon: the wisdom of God, the true temple raised on the third day, and the King whose heart never turned (Matthew 12:42; John 2:19–21; 1 Corinthians 1:30).

Core doctrine to teach

Worship and Prayer

CORE DOCTRINE 15 OF 26 · GLORY TO GOD ALONE

We were made to glorify God and enjoy him. Worship is giving God the honor he deserves, in all of life and together with his people. Prayer is bringing our requests to God, confessing our sins and thanking him for his mercies, as Solomon did at the temple. Christians now pray in Jesus' name, because he is the way to the Father. *1 Kings 8:27–30; Psalm 95:1–7; John 4:23–24; Philippians 4:6*

Answer key (Observe)

1. glory
2. contain
3. heart
4. greater

Questions people will ask

If Solomon was so wise, how could he fall so far?

Wisdom is a gift, but it does not run on autopilot. Solomon disobeyed God's clear limits and married many women who worshiped other gods, and slowly his heart followed them (1 Kings 11:1–4). Knowledge never guarantees faithfulness. That is why we need a King whose heart never turns, and a Spirit who keeps changing ours.

Closing prayer

Father, you gave Solomon wisdom and filled your house with glory. Give us wisdom for the decisions before us, and keep our hearts from drifting. Forgive us for the small compromises that turn us away from you. Thank you for Jesus, greater than Solomon, the wisdom of God and the true temple, who rose on the third day and holds us fast. Amen.